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"Inflation and unemployment are the biggest societal challenges and this year's budget aims at solving these issues. We aim to generate 20 lakh new employment opportunities for Delhi's people over the next five years. It takes a great deal of courage to even claim such an ambitious goal."

*— Arvind Kejriwal,*
*Chief Minister, Delhi*



# ROZGAR BUDGET

## DELHI GOVERNMENT'S ANSWER TO INDIA'S UNEMPLOYMENT CHALLENGE

Are we, as a nation, ready for the challenges of tomorrow? How can we engage and employ our population - our biggest strength- to perform to its potential?

As the country slowly moves into the post-pandemic era, another crisis is brewing up, which can be just as devastating. It is - the unemployment crisis. There is an urgent need to address it and for some inexplicable reason, it is not talked about as much as it should be.

India is one of the youngest nations in the world. In 2022, the median age is 28 years old, much lower than China's 37. Close to 2/3rd of the population is below 35. However, little attention is paid towards proper channelisation of this competitive advantage for the nation's benefit. The Indian economy has been on a downward spiral for many quarters now. Several factors such as demonetisation, poor implementation of GST, COVID-19 lockdown have combined to result in significant pay cuts and a trail of job losses for lakhs of people.



There have been endless reports coming from various parts of the country of candidates applying for jobs they are overqualified for. This is indicative of the challenge that lies in front of us.

The living standards of the population and their consumption pattern directly influences the state of the economy. A state in which a large chunk of its population gets respectable and well-paid employment opportunities will definitely have a thriving economy. Initiatives like free bus travel for women, a liberated startup policy are some of the measures that the Delhi has taken to encourage greater participation of the populace in the workforce.

Delhi's finance minister and Deputy Chief Minister Manish Sisodia outlined the approach of the Delhi government in the budget speech when he said, "Employment is the guarantee to growth and equality."

With the vision of making Delhi a truly global